

Player Handouts All

S00-01 - The Job

- At the edge of the warded road, a woman waits beside a loaded carriage. She looks like your contact for this job, but she has not introduced herself yet.
- What do you ask before you accept the job?
- Who checks the package without opening it?
- Who is first into the carriage?

S01-01 - Entering Sablewood

- The last warded marker slips behind you. Ahead, the road narrows and the old forest closes around the carriage.
- Who is driving?
- What is one strange detail about these enormous trees?
- Who notices the road change first?

S01-02 - The Overturned Vendor Cart

- A vendor cart lies sideways across the road. Produce and invoices spill into the mud. A polished placard blinks: INCIDENT RESPONSE EXPECTED WITHIN 3?5 BUSINESS DAYS.
- What detail in The Overturned Vendor Cart tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- What cheerful warning sign did your character dismiss as marketing copy before realizing it was true?

S01-03 - The Strixwolf Mother

- A creature steps from behind the cart: wolf-bodied, owl-faced, wings folded tight. Two pups stumble behind her. Her eyes judge whether you are danger or mercy.
- Who notices the Strixwolf pups first, and why does that matter to you?
- What do you do with your hands so the mother knows you are not hunting?
- What sound tells you this is a parent, not a monster?

S01-04 - The First Roll

- The strixwolf lowers her head. Her feathers rise along her spine. The pups go still. What do you do?
- What detail in The First Roll tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S02-01 - The Fallout Investigation

- The wreck tells a second story. Some damage is animal hunger. Some is not.

- What detail in The Fallout Investigation tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S02-02 - Eyes in the Brush

- A branch cracks somewhere beyond the road. For half a breath, the forest watches back.
- What detail in Eyes in the Brush tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S02-03 - Bramble Union Ambush

- Bramblefolk burst from the undergrowth, blades drawn. Their eyes keep flicking toward the carriage. They are here for the cargo.
- What detail in Bramble Union Ambush tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- What detail on a reclaimer's gear makes them look like a craftsperson from a hidden community rather than a disposable bandit?

S02-04 - After the Ambush

- The road is quiet again, except for the horses breathing hard and the forest shifting around the wreckage.
- What detail in After the Ambush tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S03-01 - Arrival at Hush

- You pass the ward pillar and feel a small pop, like a bubble closing behind you. The forest quiets. Friendly voices rise ahead.
- What detail in Arrival at Hush tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S03-02 - Local Clues

- Every person you meet seems to have an opinion, a custom, or a small gift to press into your hands.
- What detail in Local Clues tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S03-03 - The Clover Co-op

- The Clover Co-op climbs six stories up an ancient tree. The room smells of bread, moss tea, old wood, and somebody's terrible but enthusiastic fiddle.
- What local custom in Hush reminds you of home?
- Who accepts hospitality awkwardly, and who knows exactly what to do?
- What small repaired object in the Co-op tells you this place survives by care?

S03-04 - Firstmoss Launch Festival

- Firstmoss banners flutter overhead, some official, some clearly painted over by children with better taste.
- What detail in Firstmoss Launch Festival tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S04-01 - Through the Farms

- Blue moss glows over the crops like starlight caught in soil. The trees ahead have faces carved into every side.
- What detail in Through the Farms tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S04-02 - The Hanging Office Exterior

- A cabin-sized boulder rests below the tree, tied by thick rope to a hanging office above. It blinks with inspection seals and an old warning light.
- What detail in The Hanging Office Exterior tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S04-03 - The Whitefire Custodian

- The Custodian leans out, eyes glittering. "Oh my, you're rather late. Come in, come in before the forms notice."
- What detail in The Whitefire Custodian tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S04-04 - The Keystone Reveal

- Inside the sealed crate is a massive stone with a lion's face carved into it. The room goes quiet before anyone speaks.
- What detail in The Keystone Reveal tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S04-05 - Toward Open Vale

- The Custodian closes the crate with both hands. ?We must go to Open Vale. The magic will draw things best left uninvited.?
- What detail in Toward Open Vale tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-01 - Open Vale? Ritual Site

- The trees stop all at once. Above you, the sky opens. Someone has installed a sign here, but the stones are much older than the words on it.
- What detail in Open Vale? Ritual Site tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-02 - Short Rest Before the Storm

- For a little while, the Old Sable gives you room to breathe.
- During the short rest, who helps someone else without making a big deal of it?
- What do you prepare that is not a weapon?
- What fear do you admit before the ritual starts?

S05-03 - The Ritual Begins

- The Keystone finally answers. The Custodian lifts from the ground, glowing like a lantern about to crack.
- What detail in The Ritual Begins tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-04 - Legacy Security Skeletons

- Four skeletons tear upward from the soil, rusted swords raised like policies nobody remembered to cancel.
- What detail in Legacy Security Skeletons tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-05 - Soul-Audit Wraiths

- The wraiths drift closer. Their faces are the shape of remembered shame.
- What detail in Soul-Audit Wraiths tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-06 - Market Correction

- The runes stutter. Somewhere under the soil, something old receives permission to

continue.

- What detail in Market Correction tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S05-07 - The Ward Locks Into Place

- The Keystone sings once, low and clear. The enemies dissolve like dust remembering it was overdue.
- What detail in The Ward Locks Into Place tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S06-01 - Back in the Hanging Office

- An hour later, the Keystone hangs above the hearth, humming to itself like a sleeping storm.
- What detail in Back in the Hanging Office tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

S06-02 - The Relay Spire Hook

- ?It?s good to have heroes in the Old Sable again.?
- What detail in The Relay Spire Hook tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

Marlowe Fairwind

- Marlowe Fairwind is a playable Loreborne Elf Sorcerer pregen and the default package custodian. She receives the job with the rest of the party.
- Ask Marlowe Fairwind what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Barnacle

- Player-safe note: A slippery route-finder who fears water and unsigned obligations.
- Ask Barnacle what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Garrick Reed

- Player-safe note: A kind warrior whose mercy is an active tactic.
- Ask Garrick Reed what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Khari Nix

- Player-safe note: Loyal to people before contracts; hates predatory paperwork.
- Ask Khari Nix what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Varian Soto

- Player-safe note: Tracks unlicensed apex fauna first and asks questions later.
- Ask Varian Soto what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Strixwolf Mother

- a huge owl-faced wolf mother guarding her pups near the wreck
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Strixwolf Pup One

- Player-safe note: A wet-feathered strixwolf pup with oversized ears, bright frightened eyes, and paws too large for the body it has not grown into yet.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Strixwolf Pup Two

- Player-safe note: A crouched strixwolf pup with darker back feathers, round eyes, and a body tucked near the roots as if the forest itself might hide it.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Tamsin Vell

- a dead delivery driver at an overturned cart, with evidence that a person killed her
- Manifest clues
- Goldwater debt slip
- Cracked Hexmart ward
- A reason to treat the job as a death, not a delay

Bramble Union

- The Bramble Union: Thorn-scrap armor, hungry eyes, and old worker gear make the Bramble Union look dangerous before they look human. Slogan: We were the route.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Bramble Union Ambusher

- a road reclamer who has never done this before, and it shows
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Bramble Union Claimrunner

- a sharp-eyed lieutenant counting bodies so Kett does not have to
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Kett Alderhook

- a desperate field leader trying to seize leverage from the carriage
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Vela Bramblewick

- a scout who would rather carry a warning than a blade
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Rye Underbough

- a broad shoulder the camp's children hide behind
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Brannic Mossvein

- a kid trying not to be the first one to break
- Parley path
- Capture/mercy branch
- Evidence that the road conflict is bigger than banditry

Hush

- A real village under corporate designation, protected by ward pillars.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Hush? Community Enclave

- Goldspire's name for Hush; locals mostly ignore the trademark.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Fidget

- a restless child guide who knows the fastest ways through the village
- A route
- A local question
- A reminder that Hush is lived-in

Lausa Standworth

- a broad-shouldered elder carrying a barrel like it weighs nothing
- Local stakes
- Hospitality if treated well
- A direct read on outsider behavior

Halython Fives

- a soft-spoken clank playing a card-and-acorn game with a fox-bat nearby
- A game
- A Bramble question
- A soft clue about how locals track pressure

Yera Mossglass

- the host who keeps a labeled shelf for every kind of trouble
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Clover Co-op

- The social heart of Hush; shoes get polished and filled with trinkets.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Firstmoss Launch Festival

- Celebration of moss-ripened crops and spring abundance.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Hush Farms

- Glowing blue moss grows over fruits and vegetables.

- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Hanging Office

- A treehouse-office counterweighted by a rune-marked boulder and full of forms, runes, plants, and magic.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Whitefire Custodian

- an old faerie-like ward keeper whose exhaustion glows around the edges
- The ward truth
- A ritual path
- A relationship-based ending tone

Keystone Asset?

- Inside the sealed crate, packed in wax-paper and reassurance, sits a heavy grey stone the size of a loaf, warm to the touch, faintly humming, with a light deep inside it that is slowly going out.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Open Vale? Ritual Site

- An ancient circular clearing of standing stones and ward-light, with a freshly painted company marker staked at its edge.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Legacy Security Skeleton

- a rusted dead guard still obeying a security routine nobody living remembers
- A fight
- A mercy/release angle
- A clue that old contracts can outlive bodies

Soul-Audit Wraith

- a cold memory predator that makes care feel like an unpaid balance
- A hard combat puzzle
- A memory choice
- A chance to refuse accounting language

Relay Spire

- A slim, windswept relay tower with a beacon at the top that has lately begun to burn thin.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Spirekeeper

- a sleepless keeper of relay mechanisms, bell chains, and failing signal lights
- A human face for failing infrastructure
- A clue about missed relay signals
- A reason to care before the next adventure starts

Emeris Crown Holdings

- Emeris Crown Holdings: Emeris Crown Holdings? moves your parcel, your secret, and the blame, with cream-and-gold dignity. Slogan: Emeris Crown?: your parcel is our honor.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Goldspire Territories

- A vast bright frontier-fantasy territory of walled cities, giant forests, wet villages, relay towers, old roads, and cheerful safety promises that never quite cover the cracks.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Kazrak Industries

- Kazrak Industries: Kazrak Industries? sells adventure itself: certifications, hero ratings, and the chance to die famous. Slogan: Kazrak?: where legends are made!
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Hexmart

- Hexmart: Hexmart? is a discount-magic supercenter where every fear has a matching trinket and nothing is built to outlast the receipt. Slogan: Hexmart?: a charm for every harm!
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Mithril & Mortar

- Mithril & Mortar: Mithril & Mortar? builds the road, the bridge, the ward, and the thing that makes the bridge need replacing. Slogan: Mithril & Mortar?: we built the world you owe for.

- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Soulspire Solutions

- Soulspire Solutions: Soulspire Solutions? sells peace of mind now and, once the debt outlives you, repossesses the soul that had it. Slogan: Soulspire?: rest easy, we'll handle the rest.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

RuneSpark Entertainment

- RuneSpark Entertainment: RuneSpark Entertainment? decides which version of what happened is the one everyone remembers. Slogan: RuneSpark?: history, but better.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Sablewood? Logistics Preserve

- An ancient forest logistics preserve where colossal trees, hybrid fauna, underroot communities, route tolls, and corporate liability language all compete to define what safety means.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Old Sable

- The living old forest beneath the brand.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Goldspire Waymarkers

- Player-safe note: Glowing markers promising safety while the route is anything but safe.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Vendor Cart

- Player-safe note: Overturned cart that blocks the road and sets up the ambush mystery.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Incident Response Placard?

- A flat brass disc on a post holds a watchful glyph and a single cheerful bell. When trouble happens nearby, the glyph lights, the bell rings once, brightly, and then nothing else happens at all.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bramble Union Loot

- Player-safe note: Personal effects and evidence carried by Bramble Union members.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Inspection-Sealed Counterweight

- Player-safe note: A cabin-sized rune-marked counterweight that prevents easy access to the Custodian's office.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Ritual Countdown

- Player-safe note: Countdown die tracks progress of the ward renewal.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Forgotten Gods

- Player-safe note: Nameless old powers still honored by Hush and feared by the Custodian.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Escort Carriage

- Player-safe note: A reinforced hired carriage whose practical details make the contract feel physical and inspectable.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sealed Keystone Crate

- The package is sealed and important. Deliver it. Do not open it.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Goldspire Permit Seal

- Player-safe note: A small symbol of legitimacy that often hides who actually pays

the cost of compliance.

- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Corporate Route Bell

- Player-safe note: A polite chime that tells waymarkers and auditors the carriage belongs on the road.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sablewood Route Gate

- The road crossing where nature, signage, and corporate language first collide.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Old Sable Canopy Road

- The living road beneath the branded logistics layer, remembered by locals as a place instead of a service corridor.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Comfort Blanket

- Player-safe note: An ordinary blanket that carries more emotional weight than material value.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Ambush Roadblock

- Player-safe note: A practical barricade built from felled branches, old signposts, and stolen route hardware.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Clover Cord Bracelet

- Player-safe note: A visible sign that the party honored local custom and is being trusted by ordinary people.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Moss-Honey Jar

- Player-safe note: A sweet, earthy jar of local honey that can soften tense

- conversation without becoming magical treasure.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Hush Safe Irrigation Path

- A narrow working path through mosslit water channels that rewards trust built in Hush.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Hanging Office Winch

- Player-safe note: A counterweight-and-winch system that makes the Custodian's home feel precarious, practical, and inspectable.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Custodian Tea Cup

- Player-safe note: A tea ring on a denial letter that makes the Custodian's exhaustion visible before exposition.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Open Vale Ward Lines

- Lines of stone, moss, and old light that show the ward is infrastructure, memory, and place at once.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Ward Renewal Chime

- Player-safe note: A low tone felt in the teeth that tells the table the ward is alive, stressed, and responding.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Halython's Fox-Bat Companion

- Player-safe note: A tiny russet fox-bat with huge ears, folded wings like a cloak, clever paws, and bright eyes that make Halython's card table feel watched by something playful.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Sabine Quillon

- a brisk field agent who can brief the job if Marlowe should not carry it
- Cargo handoff
- Contract terms
- A clean start signal

Emeris Clerk

- a clerk whose calm voice makes a dangerous job sound like paperwork
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

The Grail

- The Grail: The Grail? sells salvation-shaped security: holy escorts, blessed wards, and protection from threats it has no interest in ending. Slogan: The Grail? protects the worthy.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Goldwater Financial Institution

- Goldwater Financial Institution: Goldwater Financial? keeps your valuables safe and your debt safer, because the debt is the valuable. Slogan: Goldwater? keeps what matters safe.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Artemis Inc

- Artemis Inc: Artemis Inc? makes the wild terrifying, the locals unreliable, and confidence available exclusively for purchase. Slogan: Artemis?: the wild belongs to those who can afford it.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Zephra Exchange

- Zephra Exchange: Zephra Exchange? runs the market, the toll, and the stamp that decides whether your movement counts as legal. Slogan: Zephra?: the price of everything, the value of you.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Goldspire Logistics

- Goldspire Logistics: a dull freight mark, a grey seal, and a name too boring to

remember.

- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Wardstone

- Player-safe note: A stone ward-node that protects a place, records crossings, and may skim ambient soul-signal when tied to the corporate network.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Emeris Capital Gate

- A great arch of pale carved stone three wagons wide, with toll-counters clacking beneath it and the green dark of Sablewood waiting beyond.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Emeris

- A walled city of honey-colored stone on the very lip of the great forest, where the last paved road in the world meets the first wild tree.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Athervast

- A city like a coiled crown, where gold-capped towers rise from the center and the rings spiral outward, lower and louder, until the gleam becomes rumor.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Goldspire Relay

- A twisting stone signal-spire of mirrors, flags, and courier-birds, its beacon flickering thinner than it should.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Relay Keeper

- a distant relay keeper whose silence turns the next hook into a person in danger
- A personal face for the western relay problem
- A reason to return after the one-shot
- A clue ladder without revealing the hidden thesis

GM Rules Drawer

- Player-safe note: A compact official Daggerheart rules drawer for live table support.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Duality Dice

- Player-safe note: Hope and Fear d12s rolled together, with total determining success and higher die determining spin.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Difficulty Ladder

- Player-safe note: Very Easy 5, Easy 10, Average 15, Hard 20, Very Hard 25, Nearly Impossible 30.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

D&D Conversion

- Player-safe note: A non-official aid: Daggerheart uses traits, so pick the trait that matches the fictional approach.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Official Conditions

- Player-safe note: Only Hidden, Restrained, and Vulnerable are listed as global conditions in this Atlas.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Hope

- Player-safe note: Hope softens cost, enables help and Experiences, and gives players forward momentum.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Fear

- Player-safe note: Fear lets the GM seize spotlight, reveal costs, trigger features, and advance pressure.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

GM Moves

- Player-safe note: Use GM moves to respond to Hope/Fear outcomes, reveal pressure, and keep the fiction moving.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Adversary Spotlight

- Player-safe note: Daggerheart uses spotlight flow rather than fixed initiative; adversaries act when spotlighted by the GM and features.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Adversary Attack Rolls

- Player-safe note: Adversaries roll d20 plus attack modifier against PC Evasion.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Damage / Armor

- Player-safe note: Compare damage to thresholds, mark HP by severity, and mark Armor Slots to reduce severity.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Stress

- Player-safe note: Stress marks strain, powers some abilities, and can push a character toward Vulnerable.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Armor Slot

- Player-safe note: Mark an Armor Slot to reduce incoming damage severity by one threshold.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Short Rest

- Player-safe note: Each PC chooses two rest moves; the GM gains 1d4 Fear.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Hidden

- Player-safe note: While out of sight from all foes and they do not know where you are, rolls against you have disadvantage.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Restrained

- Player-safe note: You cannot move, but you can still take actions from your current position.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Vulnerable

- Player-safe note: You are in a difficult position in the fiction; all rolls targeting you have advantage.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Hexmart Pocket Ward? (cracked)

- Player-safe note: No real ward effect; failed consumer protection charm.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Stride Salve

- Player-safe note: Clear 1 Stress or move at Far without a roll once.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Grindstone Vial

- Player-safe note: Next damage roll adds +1d6.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Lark-Moth Lantern

- Player-safe note: Soft light; once/rest ask GM one question about immediate area, no roll.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bramble-Cutter's Hook

- Player-safe note: 1d6 physical tool-knife; advantage on Finesse or Strength rolls to cut ropes, vines, snares, or free someone Restrained by brambles.

- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Compliance Stamp (forged)

- Player-safe note: Once, auto-pass bureaucratic/checkpoint gate without rolling; risky if inspected.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Firstmoss Poultice

- Player-safe note: Tend to Wounds: clear 1d4+1 HP outside a rest.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bag of Mixed Chits

- Player-safe note: Currency.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Whetcord

- Player-safe note: Once, reroll a damage die and keep the higher.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Tinker's Kit, Used

- Player-safe note: Advantage on Finesse rolls to pick locks, disarm simple traps, or jury-rig.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Soul-Quiet Charm

- Player-safe note: One use: clear 1 Stress caused by fear, memory, or wraith backlash, or gain advantage on a Presence or Knowledge roll to recover from a Soul-Audit Wraith module effect. Adaptation, not official...
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Strixwolf-Down Cloak

- Player-safe note: Once/rest, advantage on Agility roll to move silently or break line of sight.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.

- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sablewood Hybrid Fauna

- Player-safe note: Sablewood fauna mix familiar animal shapes into unfamiliar pressures: Cat-Squirrels, Giraffe-Deer, Lemur-Toads, Fox-Bats, Horse-Goats, Bullfrogs, Strixwolves, Eeligators, and stranger deep-wood hybrids.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Cat-Squirrels

- Player-safe note: Bright little cat-squirrel hybrids leap limb to limb, chattering at route signs and knocking dew from leaves before larger creatures arrive.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Giraffe-Deer

- Player-safe note: Tall, soft-eyed giraffe-deer step over the carriage road as if the road is a small inconvenience built by very short people.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Lemur-Toads

- Player-safe note: Lemur-toads swing overhead and gossip-click from wet hollows, then go abruptly silent when something hungry moves nearby.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Fox-Bats

- Player-safe note: Small fox-bats sleep under signs, steal shiny route tokens, and may tuck into a traveler's coat when the forest briefly feels kind.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Horse-Goats

- Player-safe note: Sturdy horse-goats pull road carriages with a suspicious mix of dignity, stubbornness, and snack-based negotiation.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Hunting Trees

- Player-safe note: Walking predatory trees with root legs, hooked branch arms, hollow

amber eyes, and bark faces that make ordinary forest scenery feel like it might choose a target.

- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Sablewood Route Network

- Sunken, well-worn routes through Sablewood where licensed knowledge, family route-data, and corporate coverage determine who is allowed to be safe.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Underroot

- A concealed web of tunnels and homes carved among roots where off-ledger communities survive below the dangerous surface.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Underroot Tunnels

- A Progress Countdown-based traversal environment where finding entrances and navigating similar passages matter more than fighting.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Titan's Steps

- A colossal pillar route rising more than a thousand feet through Sablewood, where merchants pay for altitude in sweat, rope, and hazard rate.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Duskwatch Exchange

- A Sablewood trade point where route knowledge, watches, and liability-backed bargains change hands above or beside the old wood.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Mountain Crabs

- Player-safe note: Granite-shelled cliff crabs with moss and alpine flowers growing on their backs, stone-heavy claws, many gripping legs, and wary eyes made for vertical roads.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

The Catcher's Cradles

- A cradle system associated with the Titan's Steps, letting Sablewood's logistics guild make vertical risk look routine.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Lucent River

- A luminous river whose blue night glow lets travelers keep time and whose waters are sold, mythologized, healed by, and hunted in.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Moonglow

- Soft blue glow from Lucent Water that keeps shining when carried away, making time, navigation, and counterfeit wellness markets possible.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The High Falls

- The place where the Lucent River drops into a cave system that once held a community nobody can fully explain.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Miremist

- A mist-wrapped place where route certainty breaks down and the forest makes navigation feel like an audit of attention.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Stones of the Vale

- Tall carved stones with mossy grooves and offerings that are always fresh, where the light lingers a half-second too long in the gaps between them.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Claravale Market

- A warm market surface where the wonder of Sablewood becomes ordinary food, handmade craft, and gossip before it becomes corporate product.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Sunless Farms

- A farming region shaped by canopy-darkness, local ingenuity, and crops that do not need corporate sunlight to grow.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Guest Privileges

- Player-safe note: Hush's guest custom grants shelter and priority for three nights, then asks visitors to trade homes or leave before generosity becomes extraction.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

The Refuge

- A prosperous Sablewood settlement where hazard rate becomes money, reputation, and a quiet measure of who survives the route.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Fire Walk

- A route or ritualized path where fire becomes both danger and logistics credential in Sablewood's local economy.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Ash Quarry

- A quarry where ash has practical value, letting the setting show resource extraction without losing the strangeness of the old wood.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Root's Hollow

- A settlement whose alchemists brave Sablewood and the Lucent River for healing water, roots, herbs, and careful local knowledge.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Latch

- A settlement or gateway whose name makes local access feel earned rather than purchased.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.

- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Sable Stills

- A settlement where strong drink, old jokes, and Sablewood craft turn danger into hospitality without making danger harmless.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Bramble Union Villages

- Vibrant, painted, moss-lit Bramble Union communities camouflaged behind mudstone walls and thorn protection.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Wandering Briar

- A mile-long living briar wall that blocks routes, shelters Wanderer families, and moves faster when its thorns taste blood.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

Bramble Stone Tumblers

- Player-safe note: Rattling tumbler devices in the Lucent River that smooth stones for Bramble armor and scare travelers who do not know the sound.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Proven Navir

- A quiet, focused Fungril retriever with goggles and an oversized bag, trying to open an untolled trade route across the river.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Xen

- A cocky, practical dwarf lapidarian with faceted nails and polished emerald stones embedded in one arm.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Yikyik Trahl

- A charismatic Katari covered in black fur, quick to laugh, and determined to see every Bramble Union village in Sablewood.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

The Sable Sinecure

- The Sable Sinecure: The Sable Sinecure? makes moving freight through a deadly forest look so polished you forget the danger is the product. Slogan: The Sable Sinecure?: danger, properly accounted.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Fire-Falcons

- Player-safe note: Sleek ember-orange falcons with coal-black wing tips and feather edges like banked fire, beautiful enough for prestige and sharp enough to make a cache feel watched.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Helena Corain

- A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Will Scild

- A slow-moving Sablewood merchant nobody disturbs, known for carrying valuable goods and tossing a small stone between his hands.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Simrith Luhaj

- A coy, intelligent, flirtatious giant with an old burn scar and a stated ambition to train a Phoenix.
- A question to ask
- A local perspective
- A grounded reason this place matters

Sablewood Hope Moments

- Player-safe note: Player-facing relief beats: shared fires, Briar maps, fox-bats, young hunters, glowing Stones, catching branches, twilight plums, and handcrafted markets.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Sablewood Fear Moments

- Player-safe note: GM pressure beats: overturned carts, twig snaps, name-echoing wind, watching eyes, seal theft, tiger-elk violence, pit traps, thorns drinking blood, and old soul-debt credentials.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Sableblade

- Growing straight up out of dark forest soil, like a sapling that decided to be a sword, is a blade of living dark wood and pale metal. It has no maker's mark and hums when your hand nears the hilt.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Ember Lake

- A hot spring lake that points toward buried divine industry and gives Sablewood a heat source older than any concession.
- Look for the busiest local gathering point.
- Ask what has changed here recently.

The Glimpse

- Player-safe note: A half-seen deer-wolf apparition made of moonlit mist, thin branches, too many reflective eyes, and firefly motes that make mercy feel older than fear.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Eeligator Scale Shield

- A round shield of overlapping slick green-grey scales catches the light like river-water. It smells of deep water, mud, and old teeth.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bramble Union Stoneweave

- A garment of thousands of tiny polished stones moves like cloth and turns thorns like armor. Every fitted piece looks cut by hands that loved the work.

- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Recall Stone

- A smooth grey pebble feels warm and ordinary until it refuses to stay where you put it. Set it down, look away, and it waits back in your palm.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Whitefire Custodian's Ward-Charm

- A small hand-carved wooden ratcoon mid-scamper has been thumb-worn smooth for luck. It is warm, and the forest feels a little kinder while you hold it.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sableleaf Shoes

- A pair of shoes sewn entirely from broad sablewood leaves sits light as breath, green-veined, and already leaning toward motion.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bugbane Berry?

- A fat red-orange berry shines a little too perfectly, with a tiny insect suspended dead-center like a pit in amber. It looks appetizing and deeply wrong.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sable Sap

- Warm amber sap beads from a crack in a huge trunk like the tree is breathing it out. It smells of honey, woodsmoke, and something older.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Twilight Plums

- Player-safe note: Dark purple twilight plums hang in cool pockets of the route, pungent enough to announce themselves before anyone sees the branch.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sunfire Lily

- Player-safe note: A bright Sunfire Lily blooms in Open Vale's seasonal light, making

the ritual ground feel vivid and specific before any explanation lands.

- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Sunless-Farm Moss

- Player-safe note: Blue-green farm moss grows in low wet beds around Hush, touched by canal water, hand tools, and the quiet work of people who know exactly how it should smell.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Vial of Briarpowder

- A small stoppered vial holds fine grey-green thorn powder that seems to drink the light. A blade edge near it looks sharper and hungrier.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bullfrog

- Player-safe note: A bull-sized swamp frog with armored warts, a heavy throat pouch, amber watching eyes, and enough mass to make a muddy bank feel like a sprung trap.
- Ask Bullfrog what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Strixwolf

- Player-safe note: A wild adult owl-wolf with a feathered ruff, lupine body, owl face, amber hunting eyes, and a low stalking posture that turns silence into a warning.
- Ask Strixwolf what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Eeligator

- Player-safe note: A blackwater predator with an alligator's jaws, an eel's coiling body, green-blue eyes, and whiskered fins that read the river before prey knows it has been noticed.
- Ask Eeligator what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Craymeleon

- Player-safe note: A chameleon-crayfish river beast with bright shell plates and independently swiveling eyes, often harnessed to pull small boats through glowing current.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.

- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Tiger-Elk

- Player-safe note: A large striped elk-predator with branching antlers and catlike shoulders, glimpsed at a distance before the forest remembers how quiet it can be.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Spidermanders

- Player-safe note: Spider-salamander hybrids coat themselves in pale ash, gripping stone with too many soft feet and leaving damp prints where the ground should be dry.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Centi-Beetles

- Player-safe note: Giant centi-beetles chew root and loam into low tunnels, making the ground sound busy even when nobody is walking.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Hellbender

- Player-safe note: The old Hellbender is the story people tell when the ground hears too much: an ancient spidermander presence said to sense movement through root, soil, and fear.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Rabbit-Gliders

- Player-safe note: Rabbit-gliders skim between low branches near the Refuge, flashing white bellies before landing in fishing nets that were not meant for them.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Moth-Possums

- Player-safe note: Moth-possums cling upside down in warm rafters and unfold soft patterned membranes when soup steam reaches them.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Turtle-Mice

- Player-safe note: Turtle-mice carry tiny shell backs through crumbs, moss, and blanket folds, making even a safehouse feel ecologically busy.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Badger-Hawks

- Player-safe note: Badger-hawks dive like feathered trouble, stealing catches off lines and sometimes trying to carry off the fisher's dignity with them.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Ratcoons

- Player-safe note: Masked ratcoons work Hush's canals and porch edges like tiny night-shift auditors, stealing moss crusts and judging poor storage habits.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Festival Moths

- Player-safe note: Festival moths gather around Firstmoss lanterns in bright clouds, turning every porch into a tiny stage and every serious speech into a potential sneeze.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Ward-Moths

- Player-safe note: Ward-moths drift along invisible pressure lines at Open Vale, their wings flashing whenever the air remembers old protection work.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Mist-Things

- Player-safe note: Mist-things move as half-seen animal shapes in low fog: not quite threat, not quite guide, but very sure they were here first.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Slyborne Hideout

- Player-safe note: A shabby but well-defended hideout among the brambles where thorn fences, patrols, and abstraction rules keep infiltration moving.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Slyborne Crew

- Player-safe note: A flexible adversary crew category for hideouts, toll lanes, and off-route pressure.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Root Blockage

- Player-safe note: A sudden shifting root blocks passage, asking whether the party digs around, cuts through, or doubles back.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Goldwater-Grail Toll Crew

- Player-safe note: Gold-and-white road enforcers in polished livery and practical armor, carrying a stamped ledger, coin box, spear, and shield like a toll can become a verdict.
- Ask Goldwater-Grail Toll Crew what they need right now.
- Watch what they protect before asking for trust.

Faceless Six

- The Faceless Six: The Faceless Six turn a friendly room into a village decision without raising their voices. Slogan: Six voices, one door.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Young Dryads

- Player-safe note: Small sapling spirits with bark-textured limbs, leaf hair, green-gold eyes, and shy defensive postures rooted around stones like children guarding a boundary.
- Give it distance before deciding it is hostile.
- Read posture, tracks, and what it is protecting.

Disposition / Resolution Track

- Player-safe note: A generic consequence tracker for how a creature, NPC group, or conflict leaves the scene: calmed, helped, fought, captured, spared, or harmed.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

NPC / Community Trust Track

- Player-safe note: A generic rapport tracker for how warm, candid, generous, or guarded a person or settlement becomes after repeated choices.

- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Ward Stability Track

- Player-safe note: Protect the Custodian during the ritual to determine whether the renewed ward is strong or unstable.
- Use this when your action is uncertain and consequences matter.
- Ask which trait fits your method.

Dungeon Workers' Alliance

- Dungeon Workers' Alliance: The Dungeon Workers' Alliance is an old labor name that survives in brass pins, hand-copied maps, and tired defiance. Slogan: Nobody clears the dungeon alone.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Perrin Oake

- a stranded fellow courier with a bent route pin
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Wicket

- a Hexmart pocket-ward vendor with too many charm strings
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Nettle

- a frightened forest scout trying not to be seen
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Auditor Holle

- a collections agent with a smile that never reaches the ledger
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Mama Suet

- a Firstmoss forager carrying food and practical comfort
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Inspector Pelt

- a checkpoint compliance officer terrified of being blamed
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

Old Gregor

- a lucid old skeleton who remembers one name and one debt
- A way forward
- A grounded question
- A scene-specific clue seed

The Midnight Cabal

- The Midnight Cabal: a whispered future-thread name for impossible jobs and locked doors that opened anyway.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

The Umbrand Consortium

- The Umbrand Consortium: a future-thread rumor about necessities that arrive after official supply says no.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Lucent Water?

- A corked bottle glows moonlit blue from inside, even in daylight, even in your pack. The water looks calm enough to sell itself.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Restorative Ash?

- A little painted tin holds fine black ash and a folded promise as long as your arm. It smells of old smoke and expensive confidence.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Fire Wine?

- A strong golden liquor sloshes in a thick jug, warm going down and warmer staying there. A paper tag insists it is not made from grapes and is absolutely not medicinal.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Goldwater Liability Token?

- A heavy brass chit with a smiling coin-face drops into your palm like a tiny verdict. The fine print is too small to read without feeling blamed.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Kazrak Adventurer Certification?

- A laminated badge shows a flattering but wrong portrait under a peeling CERTIFIED stamp. It somehow looks proud of the mistake.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Tamsin's Home-Token

- A small thumb-polished token on a cord hangs beside the torn blue scarf, warm from wear and etched with a tiny house mark instead of a company seal.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Cracked Pocket Ward?

- A cheap little ward charm sits cracked down the middle, still trying to glow through a smiling warranty sticker.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Bramble Ward-Scrap Charm Cluster

- A knot of blue ward shards, twine, and tiny salvage tags clacks softly at a Bramblefolk belt. It looks illegal only because it looks useful.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Claimrunner Serrated Blade

- A short serrated blade shows careful filing along the back edge and a handle wrapped in road cord. It is ugly in the practical way of a tool that has never had a decorative day.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.

- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Spirekeeper Relay Keyring

- A heavy ring of mismatched brass keys and blue-glass tags chimes with a sound like distant bells heard through rain.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Auditor's Verdict Ledger?

- A black ledger with bronze corners opens too neatly, as if the pages have already decided what the facts will be.
- Inspect the label, maker, or fine print.
- Use it only when the fiction says you can reach it.

Fire Solutions

- Fire Solutions?: ahead of the flames. Heroic crews, fast wagons, and a retainer for every household that wants to be saved in time.
- Ask what they publicly promise.
- Compare their slogan to what they actually do in the scene.

Action Roll

- Roll when a PC does something uncertain and consequences matter.
- Player states the action in the fiction.
- GM names the trait that best matches the method and the Difficulty.
- Player rolls Hope d12 + Fear d12 and adds trait, Experience, or advantage/disadvantage.
- Compare total to Difficulty, then resolve the Hope/Fear or critical result.

Reaction Roll

- A roll to react to danger or pressure rather than initiate action.
- Use when the GM calls for a response to sudden danger.
- Usually yes: if you mean a D&D save, look for a Reaction Roll.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Duality Dice

- Roll a Hope d12 and Fear d12 together, add modifiers, compare to Difficulty.
- Use for Action Rolls and most player-facing uncertain rolls.
- One sets the total with the other; the higher die colors the result with Hope or Fear.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Hope

- Player resource gained from Hope results and spent to help or use features.
- Use when players want to support a roll, use an Experience, Tag Team, or trigger a feature.
- Help, use an Experience, Tag Team, or use a Hope Feature.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Fear

- GM pressure resource gained on Fear results and spent to escalate.
- Use to make moves, spotlight threats, or trigger Fear features.
- The GM gains Fear and spends it to make the situation more dangerous or complicated.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Critical Success

- Matching Duality Dice create the best version of the result.
- Use whenever the Hope and Fear dice match.
- Treat it as a Critical Success: gain Hope, clear 1 Stress, and give a strong result.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Difficulty

- The target number for a roll.
- Use whenever the outcome needs a clear hinge.
- The GM sets the Difficulty; beginner hinges often sit around 10-14.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Traits

- The six broad modifiers used instead of D&D skills.
- Use the trait that matches the player's approach.
- Pick the one that matches how you do it.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Agility

- Sprint, leap, maneuver, dodge, balance, or move fast.
- Use when motion, speed, or positioning matters.
- Usually Agility if speed or body movement is the point.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Strength

- Lift, smash, grapple, hold, carry, or resist force.
- Use when force or physical power solves the problem.
- Often Strength, unless speed and movement make Agility better.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Finesse

- Control, hide, tinker, disable, or handle delicate details.
- Use for stealth, delicate tools, and precise action.
- Often Finesse, unless speed and position make Agility better.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Instinct

- Perceive, sense, navigate, track, or read danger.
- Use when the PC notices or feels what is wrong.
- Yes, most perception-style questions are Instinct.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Presence

- Charm, perform, deceive, lead, soothe, or intimidate socially.
- Use when the character's force of personality matters.
- Usually Presence.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Knowledge

- Recall, analyze, investigate, comprehend, or reason from lore.
- Use when study, records, theory, or analysis matters.
- Often Knowledge, unless noticing the clue is the main action.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Experiences

- Short expertise phrases that can add to relevant rolls by spending Hope.
- Use before a roll when the phrase truly applies.
- Yes, if it clearly helps this action and you spend Hope.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Roleplay

- The player states what their character says, does, notices, asks, or feels.
- Use whenever a scene needs a choice, reaction, question, or character moment before dice.
- No. You can speak in character, summarize in third person, or ask for help finding the words.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Table Spotlight

- A simple way to make sure each player gets room to speak and can pass.

- Use when inviting introductions, reactions, scene ownership, or quieter players into play.
- You can pass, ask a question, or give one short detail.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Connection Prompts

- Short relationship questions that build party history with consent.
- Use before play to create one or two playable relationships between PCs.
- One player offers a memory or relationship prompt; the other player answers from their character's point of view.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Concept, Aim, Tone, Subject Matter

- A quick table calibration: what this is, what we are trying to do, how it feels, and what content may appear.
- Use before play so players know the game frame and can raise concerns.
- A corporate-fantasy delivery one-shot with sincere adventure, satire, light PG-13 danger, and room to pause or soften content.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Safety Tools

- Light in-person permissions for pausing, slowing down, rewinding, stepping away, or asking for help.
- Use at the start and whenever comfort, clarity, pacing, or content needs adjustment.
- Say pause, ask for a break, ask to rewind, step away, or tell Kyle to slow down or repeat something.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Advantage / Disadvantage

- Advantage adds a d6; disadvantage subtracts a d6.
- Use when the fiction gives a clear edge or obstacle.
- Roll a d6 and add it; disadvantage subtracts it.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Help an Ally

- Spend Hope to add an advantage die to another PC's roll.
- Use when the helper can describe real help in the fiction.
- Spend Hope, describe the help, and add the help die.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Group Action Rolls

- A shared action where one PC leads and the other PCs support with reaction rolls.

- Use when several PCs work on the same task together and one clear leader makes sense.
- Choose a leader. Other PCs describe help and make reaction rolls; their successes and failures adjust the leader's action roll.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Tag Team Roll

- A bigger shared action fueled by Hope.
- Use for a dramatic two-PC combined effort.
- Yes, if the table wants a big combined moment and pays the Hope cost.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

GM Moves

- GM responses that reveal pressure, cost, danger, or consequence.
- Use on failures, Fear results, and when the fiction demands action.
- Make the next visible pressure happen.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Spotlight

- Daggerheart combat flows through spotlight rather than initiative order.
- Use to pass attention where the fiction is hottest.
- No fixed initiative; spotlight follows fiction.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Adversary Attacks

- Adversaries roll $d20 + \text{ATK}$ against PC Evasion.
- Use when an adversary gets the spotlight to attack.
- Roll $d20 + \text{ATK}$ against the target's Evasion.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Attack Rolls

- Action rolls intended to inflict harm with a weapon, spell, or unarmed strike.
- Use when a PC attacks an adversary or a feature calls for an attack roll.
- Make the relevant action roll against the target Difficulty, then roll damage on a success.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Spellcast Rolls

- Trait rolls using a character's Spellcast trait when a feature requires one.
- Use only when the feature, spell, or card calls for a Spellcast Roll.
- Use your Spellcast trait when the feature says to make a Spellcast Roll.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Evasion

- The target number adversaries roll against to hit a PC.
- Use when resolving adversary attacks.
- The closest Daggerheart equivalent is Evasion.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Proficiency

- The number that sets how many damage dice a PC rolls with weapons and many damaging features.
- Use after a successful PC attack or when a feature references Proficiency.
- Roll a number of damage dice equal to Proficiency, then add the listed modifier.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Unarmed Attacks

- Attacks without a weapon use Strength or Finesse and deal Proficiency d4 physical damage on a success.
- Use when a PC punches, kicks, tackles, or otherwise attacks without a listed weapon.
- Yes. Use Strength or Finesse as fits the fiction, then roll Proficiency d4 damage on a hit.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Attack of Opportunity

- A Warrior feature that punishes an adversary leaving Melee range.
- Use for Garrick when an adversary in Melee tries to leave that range.
- If the feature applies, make the reaction roll and choose the listed success effect from the sheet.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Damage Thresholds

- Numbers used to determine how many HP are marked from damage.
- Use after a hit deals damage.
- Compare the damage to thresholds, then mark HP by severity.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

HP

- Hit Points marked from damage severity.
- Use after damage is compared to thresholds.
- Yes, but damage severity decides how many boxes are marked.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Armor Slots

- Mark a slot to reduce incoming damage severity by one threshold.
- Use after a hit and before marking HP when armor can help.
- It can reduce the severity of a hit.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Stress

- Pressure, strain, and resource cost tracked separately from HP.
- Use when fear, effort, features, or overflow call for Stress.
- It tracks strain; if Stress maxes, the PC becomes Vulnerable until some clears.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Short Rest

- About an hour to recover and prepare; the GM gains 1d4 Fear.
- Use at the Open Vale rest beat or similar downtime.
- Each PC chooses two downtime moves. The GM gains 1d4 Fear, then play returns with refreshed pressure.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Level Up

- The reward beat where the one-shot acknowledges growth and players mark advancement.
- Use in the epilogue after the danger is over and before sequel hooks.
- Yes. In the epilogue, level up, take the reward, and let the table name what changed.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Report Choice

- The final values decision about what truth leaves the table and what gets recorded.
- Use when resolving file-honest, spin-corporate, refuse, or withhold-the-truth branches.
- It decides what truth goes on record, who is protected by silence, and what pressure follows the party.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Countdown

- A visible pressure clock for progress or danger.
- Use when time, ritual progress, or threat escalation matters.
- Tick when the fiction or result advances the clock.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Ranges

- Daggerheart uses bands like Melee, Very Close, Close, Far, and Very Far.

- Use when distance matters to weapons, spells, or positioning.
- Use the range band that best fits the fiction.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Falling / Collision Damage

- SRD guidance for falls and dangerous-speed collisions.
- Use when a fall or collision is a real consequence already established in the fiction.
- Use the SRD fall/collision guide and scale it to the range, speed, and established danger.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Fate Rolls

- A one-die roll when the GM leaves an outcome entirely to chance.
- Use when the PCs are not directly causing the result but chance should decide a detail.
- Name the stakes first, then roll one Duality Die and interpret it openly.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Conditions

- The Atlas uses only official global conditions: Hidden, Restrained, Vulnerable.
- Use when a rule or clear fiction creates one of those states.
- They change tactical position in specific official ways.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Temporary Effects

- Temporary conditions or effects can be cleared through the listed move, feature text, natural end, or spell/Fear procedure.
- Use when a feature says an effect or condition is temporary.
- Use the effect text first. If it is a temporary condition, clear it through the appropriate move or spotlight procedure.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Hidden

- A target is unseen or its position is unknown.
- Use when the fiction supports being unseen or concealed.
- Enemies have a harder time targeting what they cannot see or locate.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Restrained

- A target cannot move freely, though it may still act from position.
- Use when physically trapped, grabbed, bound, or pinned.

- If the fiction says they are physically trapped, yes.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Vulnerable

- Rolls targeting the Vulnerable target have advantage.
- Use when the target is exposed by rule, feature, or clear fiction.
- Attacks or rolls against the target have advantage.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

D&D to Daggerheart

- Quick translation aid for D&D-trained instincts.
- Use when a player asks for a D&D skill, save, AC, or initiative.
- Traits, Hope/Fear, spotlight, Evasion, thresholds, and narrative consequences.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

FAQ

- Fast beginner answers for live teaching.
- Use when a player asks a table-basics question.
- Answer the exact question and return to the scene.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Five Roll Outcomes

- Every action roll resolves into one of five table results: critical success, success with Hope, success with Fear, failure with Hope, or failure with Fear.
- Check doubles first for Critical Success.
- If not a critical, compare total to Difficulty.
- At or above Difficulty succeeds; below Difficulty fails.
- Hope spin gives Hope and a cleaner/kinder edge; Fear spin gives the GM Fear and a cost or complication.

Connection Questions

- Daggerheart-style prompts that let players define safe, playable relationships before the first scene.
- Use during Session Zero, character introductions, and optional party-bond refresh beats.
- Offer one relationship prompt, then let the other player answer in their own words and keep only the part both players like.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Character Creation

- The beginner sequence for choosing identity, ancestry, community, class, traits, equipment, Experiences, and connections.

- Use during Session Zero or when importing a new Level 1 PC into the one-shot.
- Start with who the character is, then ancestry, community, class/subclass, traits, Experiences, equipment, and connection questions.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Heritage

- The broad character identity layer made from ancestry, community, and the player's chosen story details.
- Use when a player asks what shaped their character before the job.
- Use the exact sheet rules for ancestry/community features; use the rest as story permission and roleplay texture.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Ancestry

- A character's people/species choice and its official feature package.
- Use at character creation and when ancestry fiction clearly explains how a PC perceives or approaches a moment.
- Use the printed ancestry feature. For scene flavor, give a distinct clue angle without changing math unless the table grants advantage or adjusts...
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Community

- A character's social origin and the official feature tied to that origin.
- Use at character creation and when a PC's upbringing explains what they know, fear, or notice.
- Use the printed community feature and let the background shape how the same clue is discovered.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Class and Subclass

- A PC's core playstyle, starting values, features, domains, and Hope Feature.
- Use when explaining what a pegen is good at or when a feature changes a scene.
- It tells you your main features, starting Evasion, HP, domain access, and the kinds of actions your sheet supports well.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Domain Cards

- Ability cards selected from a class's domains and arranged between loadout and vault.
- Use when a player asks what their cards do, when a rest allows swapping, or when a feature is triggered.
- Your active loadout gives usable abilities. During rests, official rules control when cards move between loadout and vault.

- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Damage Rolls

- After a successful attack, roll the listed weapon, spell, or adversary damage dice and compare the total to thresholds when needed.
- Use after a hit or when a feature calls for damage.
- After the attack succeeds. Roll the listed damage, then compare it to the target's thresholds or stat block instructions.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Long Rest

- Extended downtime recovery; the GM gains 1d4 plus the number of PCs in Fear and may advance a long-term countdown.
- Use between adventures or when a sequel session gives the party real downtime.
- Not during immediate danger. Use short rest inside the one-shot; save long rest for continuation play and long-term pressure.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Disposition / Resolution Track

- A module-facing tracker for how a creature, NPC group, or faction leaves a scene: helped, calmed, fought, captured, spared, or harmed.
- Use for Strixwolf and Bramble-style outcomes that should ripple later.
- Track what the table actually did and how the affected side now feels about them.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

NPC / Community Trust Track

- A module-facing tracker for rapport with a person or settlement.
- Use when repeated choices change how warm, candid, generous, or guarded an NPC/community becomes.
- High trust makes help warmer and clearer. Low trust still lets play continue, but with distance, fewer gifts, or harder social positioning.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Hope & Fear Moments

- A table texture tool for translating Hope/Fear spins into local relief beats or pressure beats.
- Use when a roll's spin needs an immediate scene-specific color.
- Resolve the official result first, then add a local Hope beat or Fear beat that fits the place.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

GM Rules Drawer

- The Atlas quick-reference drawer that gathers rule cards, conditions, conversion, and beginner reminders.
- Use when Kyle needs a fast answer without leaving Run Mode.
- Open the drawer, search the mechanic, read the compact answer, then return to the scene.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

Roll Slider

- Kyle's optional degree-of-success overlay: the total says how far above or below Difficulty the result lands while Hope/Fear sets the spin.
- Use when a clue, negotiation, or set piece benefits from richer tiers than pass/fail.
- It tells you how much they get: botch, miss, hit, clean, soar, or crit, while Hope/Fear still colors the result.
- Return to the fiction with the concrete result, cost, or benefit.

SZ-00-STANDBY - Standby Welcome Poster

- Welcome to Peril to Profit: The Goldspire Messengers.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SZ-00B - Welcome, Logistics, and GM Role

- This is a standalone one-shot at Mox. We are here to tell a complete story tonight, learn the game as we go, and make sure everyone has enough information to participate comfortably.
- Your GM is Kyle, he/him. Kyle has 15+ years running in-person and online TTRPGs.
- GM style for Daggerheart: story-first, roleplay-friendly, and mechanics in service of the table's fun.
- Kyle plays the world, keeps the rules moving, asks questions, and helps everyone get spotlight.
- You play one character. Say what they try to do, ask questions, and make choices from their point of view.

SZ-00C - Player Introductions

- Before characters, let's meet the people at the table. Short is perfect, and passing is always okay.
- Your name and pronouns if you want to share them.
- Your TTRPG or Daggerheart experience level.
- One fun fact, comfort note, or what you are hoping for tonight.
- You can pass and come back.

SZ-00 - Ready to Start / Table Frame

- This is a beginner-friendly Daggerheart one-shot. You do not need to know the rules

ahead of time. We will learn by playing.

- You are hired contractors or trusted associates escorting a sealed delivery through the Goldspire Territories.
- The job looks simple. It will not stay simple.
- Tone: sincere fantasy adventure, corporate satire, and a little dark whimsy.
- Share spotlight, ask questions, pass when needed, help other characters look cool, and respect safety tools.

SZ-01 - Concept, Aim, Tone, Subject Matter

- We are playing a fantasy delivery job in the Goldspire Territories: dangerous roads, strange magic, communities under pressure, and corporations trying to turn everything into paperwork.
- Concept: a corporate-fantasy delivery job that becomes morally complicated.
- Aim: learn Daggerheart, build the party, protect a community, and discover what the sealed delivery means.
- Tone: mostly sincere fantasy adventure, with corporate satire and dark whimsy around the edges.
- Subject matter: fantasy danger, animal peril, ambush, death, corporate exploitation, undead, and memory or fear magic.

SZ-01B - Rating / Content Notes

- Think adult PG-13-ish fantasy adventure. There will be combat and danger, but violence descriptions stay light unless the table chooses to make a moment more intense.
- This is an adult game, but not a grimdark or graphic game.
- Likely content: combat, peril, ambushes, monsters, undead, corporate exploitation, fear or memory magic, and morally complicated choices.
- Animal peril may appear. Violence against animals is optional and can be softened, avoided, or redirected.
- If anything I describe or any action at the table makes you uncomfortable, say pause, slow down, rewind, or break.

SZ-01C - Tonight's Shape / Pacing

- We will start with Session Zero, move into the delivery job, follow the route through escalating complications, and take breaks so the table can breathe.
- Session Zero: safety, rules, characters, and connections.
- Opening contract: the sealed delivery and why you took the job.
- Road trouble: the route proves less safe than advertised.
- Hush and investigation: meet people, ask questions, and decide who to trust.

SZ-02 - Safety Tools / Table Agreement

- You do not need to justify a boundary. If something is not fun, too intense, or not for tonight, we can pause, redirect, fade to black, or move on.
- Open Door: you can step away at any point and return when ready.

- Simple table signal: say pause, slow down, can we rewind, or break.
- If you missed something, ask me to repeat it.
- If I am moving too fast, ask me to slow down.

SZ-02B - Player Expectations / Shared Table Care

- This works best when everyone is engaged, respectful, and helping the table have fun. You are responsible for your own fun and for noticing the other people at the table too.
- Engage with the story and ask questions.
- Invite other players in: ask them what their character thinks, notices, or does.
- Speak when it is your turn, and be mindful of how much space you are taking.
- Only participate at the level you are comfortable with.

SZ-03 - Daggerheart Rules Snapshot

- Daggerheart is narrative fantasy. The GM describes the world, players describe what their characters do, and we roll when the outcome is risky, uncertain, or dramatic.
- Describe what your character tries to do.
- If it is risky or uncertain, roll Hope and Fear d12s.
- Add the trait that fits your approach.
- Tell the GM the total and whether Hope or Fear was higher.

SZ-04 - Character Selection / Sheet Orientation

- In front of you: a character sheet, quick rules card, connection sheet, and safety card. Your sheet tells you who your character is, what they are good at, what they can do, and how much pressure or harm they can take.
- Look for: name and vibe, traits, Experiences, weapons/actions, Hope, Stress, Hit Points, Armor, and class/domain abilities.
- Pick or confirm a character. If you chose ahead of time, make sure the sheet in front of you matches that choice.
- Marlowe Fairwind - playable Loreborne Elf Sorcerer pregen and default package custodian; she receives the job with the crew.
- Barnacle - sneaky rogue with questionable logistics instincts.

SZ-05 - Character Introductions

- Short is good. You can pass and come back.
- Name / pronouns
- Ancestry, community, class, or vibe
- What do we notice first?
- Why did you take this job?

SZ-06 - Connections Workshop

- Offer, don't overwrite. A connection prompt is your character's perspective: what they remember, saw, believed, misunderstood, felt, or interpreted.

- The other player can accept it, clarify it, complicate it, soften it, or pass.
- Yes, and...
- Yes, but...
- Can we soften that?

SZ-07 - What PCs Know

- You are on a delivery job to the village of Hush. The cargo is sealed, valuable, and not supposed to be opened without permission.
- You are escorting one sealed cargo unit.
- It is important, guarded, and not supposed to be opened without permission.
- It is going to Hush, a village in the Goldspire Territories.
- The route crosses Sablewood Logistics Preserve: a vast fantasy forest, called Old Sable by some locals.

SZ-08 - Launch Checklist / Cut to Prologue

- You are on a delivery job to the village of Hush with a sealed crate. You know enough to start; the rest will come through play.
- The route waits.
- The contract is signed.
- The crate is sealed.
- We begin now.

PROLOGUE - Prologue: The Contract

- You have a courier contract: escort a sealed package through a huge old forest to a village and get paid on delivery.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S00-01 - The Job

- At the edge of the warded road, a woman waits beside a loaded carriage. She looks like your contact for this job, but she has not introduced herself yet.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-goldspire-territories - Goldspire Territories Location Map

- A vast bright frontier-fantasy territory of walled cities, giant forests, wet villages, relay towers, old roads, and cheerful safety promises that never quite cover the cracks.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-emeris-capital-gate - Emeris Capital Gate Location Map

- The Emeris Capital Gate is a bright western threshold of pale carved stone, toll counters, route-charms, fried dough, caravan noise, and the green mouth of Sablewood beyond the road.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S01-01 - Entering Sablewood

- The last warded marker slips behind you. Ahead, the road narrows and the old forest closes around the carriage.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-sablewoodtm-logistics-preserve - SablewoodTM Logistics Preserve Location Map

- The preserve stretches beyond the path, too vast to read at once. The route ahead stays focused on the hanging home.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-old-sable - Old Sable Location Map

- Older stones sit half-hidden near the path, weathered enough that nobody here could have made them recently.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-sablewood-route-gate - Sablewood Route Gate Location Map

- The route gate is where polished assurance meets wet bark, old stone, and a forest that has not signed anything.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

ACT-ONE - Act One: The Logistics Incident

- The warded city is behind you now. The road runs on under a canopy so high you never see it move, and the carriage rocks along ruts older than any company that claims this forest. The job is simple: deliver the...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S01-02 - The Overturned Vendor Cart

- Your steeds haul the carriage around a tight bend and stop hard. The path ahead is blocked: a vendor cart lies overturned, its fruit, vegetables, and spilled preserves scattered across the trail. Something has been...
- Choose one visible approach.

- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-S01-02 - Overturned Vendor Cart Scene Board

- A vendor cart blocks the bend. Scattered fruit, broken jars, torn canvas, and muddy wheel ruts make the road feel suddenly too narrow. Something moves on the far side.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-sablewood-route-network - Sablewood Route Network Location Map

- Sunken, well-worn routes through Sablewood where licensed knowledge, family route-data, and corporate coverage determine who is allowed to be safe.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S01-03 - The Creature and Her Young

- From behind the cart steps a large creature: the body of a wolf, the face of an owl, broad feathered wings folded along its back. It lifts its head from the meal and studies you, unhurried, deciding whether you are a...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-COMBAT-S01-03 - Creature Mercy / Defensive Escalation Battlefield

- The road tightens around the wreck. The creature plants herself between you and the young, wings half-open, claws in the mud. The cart, the ditch, and the low branches turn the bend into a narrow standoff.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S01-04 - The First Action Roll - Reading the Creature

- The creature is wary of every movement you make. Let's find out how she reacts. This is your first roll: grab your two d12s, add your Presence, and tell me the total, plus which die came up higher. If you have an...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

ACT-TWO - Act Two: Cargo Reclaimers

- The animal is behind you, one way or another. But the wreck did not arrange itself, and the more you look, the less this feels like bad luck. Someone wanted a wreck here. Someone wanted you here. The forest the company...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S02-01 - The Fallout Investigation

- With the creature dealt with, the wreck is yours to read. Up close, the story stops adding up. The cart was stripped clean before anything wild got to it. The driver's wounds are not all bites. And worked into one...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S02-02 - Eyes in the Brush

- The road feels watched. A branch snaps where no wind moved it. The hybrid animals have gone quiet: lark-moths, fox-bats, all of them holding their breath the way you are holding yours. Something is keeping pace with...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-S02-03 - Cargo Reclaimer Ambush Battlefield

- The road tightens into an ambush site: mud under the carriage wheels, thorn cover on both sides, and figures moving between the brush and the cargo line. The path forward is blocked by people, not beasts.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S02-03 - The Ambush

- Four figures rise from the brush in a clatter of breaking branches: ragged, wiry, armored in lashed river-stone and thorn. Their blades are mismatched, half of them salvaged. A fifth hangs back, sharper-eyed, clearly...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-bramble-union-villages - Bramble Union Villages Location Map

- The forest opens into hidden homes: thorn-warren shelters, cook-fires, moss lamps, patched tools, and people who go very quiet when strangers arrive. Whatever happened on the road, this place is not a camp of raiders...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-wandering-briar - The Wandering Briar Location Map

- A wall of thorn opens where there was only forest a moment ago. The path inside is green, narrow, and warm, as if the briar itself is holding its breath to let you pass. Lantern-light glows deeper in, touching salvaged...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S02-04 - After the Ambush

- The brush goes still. Whatever you did, it is done. The horses breathe hard. The road smells like wet thorn, churned mud, and adrenaline fading too slowly. Among what was dropped, you see gear that does not look like...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

ACT-THREE - Act Three: Seeking a Custodian

- The road softens. The trees do not change, but the air does: warmer, kinder, like a held breath finally letting go. Ahead, lantern-light and music gather around ordinary people who feel safe. Somewhere in this village...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S03-01 - Arrival at Hush

- A tall stone pillar rises beside the road, carved top to bottom with old protective marks and newer brass stamps. As the carriage passes it, you feel a small sensation like a bubble popping. The forest hush gives way...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-hush - Hush Location Map

- Hush gathers under the colossal trees: warm windows, lantern branches, low roofs, and paths leading toward a tree-tavern, market stalls, festival noise, and the farms beyond.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-hushtm-community-enclave - Hush? Community Enclave Location Map

- Near the village entrance, a polished official sign and neat route stones sit beside handmade clover charms and scuffed local paths. The sign looks newer than the place, and colder.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-firstmoss-launch-festival - Firstmoss Launch Festival Location Map

- The lane opens into a village festival: green lanterns, mossfruit cakes, damp banners, children under watchful eyes, and music doing its best to be louder than the ward's uneven hum.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-sunless-farms - The Sunless Farms Location Map

- Under the canopy, farms grow without full sun: blue-green rows, dark wet soil, careful water paths, and tools hung where rain and sap cannot ruin them.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-clover-co-op - Clover Co-op Location Map

- Inside the village, the Co-op is a warm public room of tea steam, shoe lines, gift shelves, chipped mugs, and people deciding whether these travelers are guests, trouble, or both.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S03-02 - Local Clues

- The town is happy to talk. Everyone seems to know the person you are looking for, though they are protective of her. A friendly local can point the way, if the town decides you are safe enough to send toward someone it...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-hush-safe-irrigation-path - Hush Safe Irrigation Path Location Map

- A narrow farm path follows glowing irrigation water through moss, boards, root lips, and quiet field marks. It is easy to walk when someone has shown you what the marks mean.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-lucent-river - The Lucent River Location Map

- The Lucent River carries blue light through Sablewood like a road that refuses to become a road.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-claravale-market - The Claravale Market Location Map

- Claravale Market turns forest wonder into breakfast, tools, gossip, and pocket-sized miracles: local stalls beside a few too-clean branded carts.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S03-03 - The Clover Co-op

- The Clover Co-op climbs the trunk of an ancient tree, level stacked on level,

crowded with music and good-natured noise. A friendly local stops you at the door: newcomers hang their shoes on the line strung across the...

- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S03-04 - Firstmoss Launch Festival

- You have arrived during the Firstmoss Launch Festival. The town celebrates the season's first moss rising on the Sunless Farms crops, the promise of fresh fruit and full tables ahead. There is a good-natured...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-hush-farms - Hush Farms Location Map

- The last cultivated fields thin into carved trees and blue moss-light. The path ahead leaves village warmth behind.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

ACT-FOUR - Act Four: The Hanging Office

- The town thins behind you, fields giving way to forest again. The trees here wear faces, hundreds of them carved into the bark, eyes turned every direction. Somewhere past them lives the person you were sent to find...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S04-01 - Through the Farms

- Past the last homes of the village, the crops change: fruits and vegetables wear a thin layer of glowing blue moss that pulses softly with warmth as you pass. Then the cultivated land ends, and the preserve returns...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-hanging-office - The Hanging Office Location Map

- A home hangs in the canopy above a carved counterweight stone. Yellow-green light moves behind its windows.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S04-02 - The Hanging Office Exterior

- Up close, cabin undersells it. A home hangs from a braid of rope as thick as a giant's forearm, tied to a massive branch and counterweighted by a boulder the size of the cabin itself. The whole thing sways like...

- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S04-03 - The Whitefire Custodian

- The home lowers, and from it steps a being seven feet tall: part humanoid, part firefly, moving in slow drifts broken by sudden jerky motions. Her face is hard to read, but her voice carries every feeling plainly. She...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S04-04 - The Keystone Reveal

- The Custodian unfolds her home like a blossoming flower and draws the crate inside, sealing it open again as a workshop. She breaks the seal. Inside lies a massive stone carved with a lion's face. She goes still, then...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-open-vale-ward-lines - Open Vale Ward Lines Location Map

- The path ahead begins to glow in thin lines through earth and bark, all converging toward the Open Vale.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S04-05 - Toward Open Vale

- The Custodian gathers what she needs with the brisk energy of someone much younger than she looks. "The Open Vale is where the ward was first forged," she says. "It is where it must be renewed." She looks at each of...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

ACT-FIVE - Act Five: The Ward Renewal

- The carriage pulls into a perfect circle of clearing, the only place in the preserve where the trees pull back and let you see the open sky. This is where it ends. The Custodian says the ward was first forged here, and...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-01 - The Open Vale Site

- The clearing is a perfect circle, the only break in the endless canopy: open sky above for the first time in days. The Custodian speaks softly as you arrive. This is where she first forged the ward pillars that keep...
- Choose one visible approach.

- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-S05-03 - Holding the Line Tactical Map

- The ritual clearing becomes a battlefield because the ward itself is under pressure. The Custodian and Keystone hold the center while old security bodies and audit-cold spirits test every gap around them.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-open-valetm-ritual-site - Open Vale? Ritual Site Location Map

- The trees break around an old clearing of standing stones, wet grass, and pale ward-light. Official markers call it Open Vale, but the place feels older than the paperwork and more awake than a ruin.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-stones-of-the-vale - The Stones of the Vale Location Map

- The clearing's stones make the ward visible: blue seams, old cuts, moss-lit lanes, and a center that pulls every sound inward before the ritual begins.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-02 - The Ritual Begins

- The Custodian lets out a shrill cry. "The Keystone has finally responded! Surround me, the ritual must begin or I'll lose the pathway! Hurry!" Her glow swells, her eyes roll back, and the carriage lifts a foot off the...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-03 - Holding the Line

- The skeletons come in a clatter of rust and bone: not clever, but endless, and all of them reaching for the glowing figure at the center. For every one you put down, the ritual's clock ticks a notch closer to done. But...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-moonglow - Moonglow Location Map

- Soft blue glow from Lucent Water that keeps shining when carried away, making time, navigation, and counterfeit wellness markets possible.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-miremist - The Miremist Location Map

- The Miremist makes certainty expensive: fog, wet roots, and route sounds that arrive from the wrong distance.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-04 - The Soul-Audit Wraiths

- The drifting things reach you, and they do not swing for your body. One presses a cold hand to a face and reaches inside, dredging up something buried. The other simply passes through a body like a door, and for a...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-05 - The Peak

- It all comes at once: the dead clawing up faster, the wraiths pressing in, the Custodian's glow guttering like a candle in wind. The clock is close, but so is disaster. Every choice now costs something: guard her and...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-COMBAT-S05-05 - Peak Battle: Skeleton Pressure

- The wraiths drift closer. Their faces are the shape of remembered shame.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-06 - The Ward Renewed

- As you land the blow that drops the last threat, the ritual ends. The carriage crashes back to earth and the Keystone blazes with arcane light. Then a soundless explosion erupts from the Custodian, washing outward...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-COMBAT-S05-06 - Peak Battle: Wraith Pressure

- The runes stutter. Somewhere under the soil, something old receives permission to continue.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S05-07 - Beyond the Contract

- An hour later, back in the treehouse, the Keystone hangs suspended over a rumbling hearth-fire. The Custodian, older now, exhaustion plain in her voice, folds herself

into an over-stuffed chair. "You fought hard. I'm...

- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

EPILOGUE - Epilogue: Beyond the Contract

- The screeching is gone. The clearing is quiet, the open sky calm. Somewhere west, a city you may never see is waking up safe because of what you did tonight. The Custodian is already shuffling you back toward warmth...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S06-01 - Back in the Hanging Office

- An hour later, back in the treehouse, the Keystone hangs suspended above a rumbling hearth-fire, glowing soft and settled. The Custodian, older now, the night's work plain in her voice, folds into an over-stuffed...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

S06-02 - The Relay Spire Hook

- The Custodian leads you out of the treehouse, out of the forest itself, to look down on the green expanse from above. Twisting stone spires break through the treeline, each with a flame flickering in its tower like a...
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-relay-spire - Relay Spire Vista

- Stone spires break through the treeline, each holding a small flame. One light westward burns weaker than the rest.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-goldspire-relay - The Goldspire Relay Hook Context

- The Relay stands westward beyond the trees, a beacon that should burn steady and does not.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAPS - Location Maps

- Reference maps for locations that do not belong to a single scene beat.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-old-sable-canopy-road - Old Sable Canopy Road Location Map

- The canopy road feels like travel through the forest's memory: dim green light, root-shadow bends, and old markers half-swallowed by moss.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-emeris-capital - Emeris Location Map

- A walled city of honey-colored stone on the very lip of the great forest, where the last paved road in the world meets the first wild tree.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-athervast - Athervast Location Map

- This distant capital reference is not part of the player route today.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-underroot - Underroot Location Map

- Underroot is not a dungeon; it is a concealed neighborhood of root rooms, low lanterns, and people who survive below the route economy.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-underroot-tunnels - Underroot Tunnels Location Map

- A Progress Countdown-based traversal environment where finding entrances and navigating similar passages matter more than fighting.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-titan-s-steps - The Titan's Steps Location Map

- The Titan's Steps climb through height, rope, sweat, and hazard pay until travel itself feels like a negotiated risk.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-duskwatch-exchange - Duskwatch Exchange Location Map

- Duskwatch Exchange is where route knowledge changes hands quietly, because the forest charges more for ignorance.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-catcher-s-cradles - The Catcher's Cradles Location Map

- The Catcher's Cradles make vertical danger look routine: suspended nets, rescue platforms, and the quiet pride of people who catch mistakes for a living.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-high-falls - The High Falls Location Map

- The High Falls drown speech in blue-white spray where the Lucent River drops into a cave mouth nobody fully explains.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-refuge - The Refuge Location Map

- The Refuge is prosperous because people learned how to survive Sablewood, not because Sablewood became safe.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-fire-walk - The Fire Walk Location Map

- The Fire Walk smells of ash, resin, and ritualized courage, a path where heat is both danger and credential.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-ash-quarry - The Ash Quarry Location Map

- The Ash Quarry turns ancient residue into industry: gray terraces, warm dust, and workers who know which piles still remember fire.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-root-s-hollow - Root's Hollow Location Map

- Root's Hollow smells of tinctures, river water, and careful survival, a place where alchemists learn from Sablewood because they have to.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-latch - The Latch Location Map

- The Latch feels like a threshold that decides whether access is earned, bought, or refused.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-the-sable-stills - The Sable Stills Location Map

- The Sable Stills are warm, smoky, and sharper than they seem, turning old wood, strong drink, and local jokes into hospitality with teeth.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

MAP-LOC-ember-lake - Ember Lake Location Map

- Ember Lake steams under cool canopy air, a hot spring mirror that suggests something older is still working below Sablewood.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD - Sablewood Field Guide

- Fast reference for Sablewood locations, communities, factions, resources, creatures, and future hooks.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD-GUIDE - Sablewood Field Guide

- Sablewood is old, lush, dangerous, and bigger than the route contract.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD-ROUTES - Routes / Underroot / Relays

- Stay on the path unless you know who made the path.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD-FACTIONS - Factions / Communities

- Every group here has a survival strategy.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD-GEAR - Gear / Creatures / Hazards

- Everything useful here was earned from a dangerous place.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

SABLEWOOD-RUMORS - Rumors / Future Hooks

- Some stories in Sablewood are older than the road.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEATS - Cheat Sheets

- Fast reference slides for live play.
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-GM - GM Rules Reference

- CHEAT-GM - GM Rules Reference
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-CONDITIONS - Conditions

- CHEAT-CONDITIONS - Conditions
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-PC - PC / Player Cheat Sheet

- CHEAT-PC - PC / Player Cheat Sheet
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-LOOT - Loot Board

- CHEAT-LOOT - Loot Board
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-PRONUNCIATION - Pronunciation Guide

- CHEAT-PRONUNCIATION - Pronunciation Guide
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

CHEAT-STATE - Current State Summary

- CHEAT-STATE - Current State Summary
- Choose one visible approach.
- Ask one practical question before acting.

Export Stamp

